Project brief | Group project

International Student Support Assistant

Imaduddin Sheikh | Group project | Ideation, problem selection, prompt testing, and assistant planning.

Overview

Our group explored a conversational assistant for international students with questions about studying in the United States. We chose the problem because group members were familiar with the challenges students face. The resulting prototype is available as DSO Daddy, an independent student project focused on IWU-related student support.

My contribution

I contributed to ideation, choosing the problem, testing prompts, and planning the assistant. Platform-building trials were carried out by other group members. This brief describes my contribution within that shared effort.

The goal

Explore whether a conversational interface could make international-student information easier to approach. We prioritized student-related visa questions before broader work-visa topics and planned to direct users to a designated school official or immigration lawyer when needed.

Problem selection and scope

The group considered both an international-student assistant and a fitness chatbot. We chose student support based on our familiarity with the problem. Early planning included questions about travel during Optional Practical Training (OPT), entering the United States, and transferring schools.

Prompt exploration

I participated in prompt testing as part of the planning process. The group notes record using ChatGPT, Claude, and Copilot with the same initial question: “What documents are needed for travel on OPT?” The notes contain initial questions and sample answers, but do not preserve separate outputs from every platform or a scored comparison.

From planning to prototype

One teammate explored Lovable to create an application, while another explored a Chatbase trial. The group recorded a positive initial response to the Lovable prototype. My contribution remained focused on the idea, problem selection, prompts, and assistant planning.

The prototype

The live application offers a chat input and entry points for Visa & I-20, Admissions, CPT & OPT, and Student life. It identifies itself as an independent student project rather than an official IWU service and advises users to confirm their situation with a designated school official.

Value and current limits

The project brings a defined audience, an initial question set, and assistant planning together in a working conversational prototype. Its intended audience is international students seeking information about studying at IWU. The available documentation does not establish answer accuracy, complete official-source coverage, a retrieval architecture, measured student outcomes, or a structured evaluation.

Project record

This brief consolidates the group's DSO Daddy planning notes and my confirmed contribution. It describes the work completed and documented so far. Immigration answers from the working notes are omitted because they have not been verified as guidance.

Explore the prototype

Live prototype: https://iwu-chatbot.lovable.app/